

Taras Pedchenko

Engineering Leader & Cloud Architect

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Profile

My business values are people, transparency, technology, processes, and excellence. Technology executive with 20+ years of progressive experience spanning cloud architecture, engineering management, DevOps/SRE leadership, hands-on implementation and product delivery. Track record of building and scaling engineering teams (up to 68 members), managing infrastructure budgets exceeding \$1M/year, and driving cloud transformation initiatives that reduced costs by up to 68%. Delivered complex platforms across fintech, automotive, e-commerce, and telecom domains. Former CIO at a fintech startup where I built the product and infrastructure from scratch through PCI DSS certification and reached profitability within 18 months. Currently leading Azure & SRE units company-wide at Intellias while serving as cloud architect and SRE on a major fintech project. Seeking a CTO or EDM role to apply strategic vision and hands-on technical leadership to build exceptional products and high-performing teams.

Skills & Competencies

People Management:

Communication, Personal Effectiveness, Presentation Skills, Time Management, Cognitive Skills, Leadership, Project HR / Delegation, Organizing the Group, Conflict & Stress Management

Project Management:

Strategic Management, Quality Management, SDLC, Stakeholder Management, PM Tools & Techniques, FinOps, Presales & Sales, Change Management, Agile / Scrum / Nexus

Operational Resilience:

ICT Risk Assessment, PCI DSS, GDPR, ISO 22301, SRE, NIST SP 800-53/61, Resilient Architecture, DORA, CISA, RASCI, NIS2, CRA, eIDAS2, Incident Detection & Playbooks, Centralized Logging (OTel), Backup & DR

Programming, AI & Markup:

AI (Claude, Bedrock, OpenAI), LLMOps, Prompt Engineering, Terraform (HCL), Python, SQL, Bash, PowerShell, Golang, .NET, Java, YAML / JSON / Helm, HTML / CSS / JS

Cloud & Virtualization:

Azure, AWS, Kubernetes (AKS/EKS), Terraform / Terragrunt, Docker, Ansible, VMware (vSphere/ESXi), nginx / IIS / Apache

Observability & CI/CD:

Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry (OTEL), New Relic, PagerDuty, ELK, Splunk, DataDog, Honeycomb, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub, Bitbucket, Azure DevOps

RDBMS & NoSQL:

MS SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra, CouchDB, RabbitMQ, Kafka

Administration & Security:

High Availability, Security / TLS / SSL, VPN / Networking, Consul, Zero Trust / IAM, WAF / DDoS Protection, Secrets Management

Key Highlights

20+ Years in IT **68** Engineers managed **68%** Cloud cost reduction **50+** Projects globally

99.99% SLA uptime **12+** Years PCI compliance

Experience

Head of Azure & SRE Units + EDM

Apr 2022 — Present | Intellias — Spain

- Heading Azure & SRE units company-wide: infrastructure strategy, modernization, hiring, and knowledge transfer
- Developing and scaling Cloud & DevOps service offerings, contributing to presales, sales, client engagement, assessments, and partnership growth
- Building strategic partnership with Microsoft for Azure infrastructure specialization
- Mentoring senior engineers into leadership roles (Principal, Team Lead, Architect)

CTO Advisor & SRE | Jan 2026 — Present

- Enhancing observability, reliability, and performance of mission-critical financial services as a hands-on SRE
- Advising CTO on Well-Architected Framework adoption roadmap and Landing Zones implementation
- Building and aligning a platform engineering team; implementing EKS clusters including EKS Anywhere
- Establishing SRE processes with shared observability context across development teams to proactively prevent incidents in high-load financial services

Stack: Java, Claude Enterprise, OpenTelemetry, Honeycomb, ELK, AWS, Private Cloud, EKS, Landing Zones, Well-Architected Framework

Cloud Architect / EDM | Apr 2023 — Dec 2025

- Led cloud architecture for a premium EV brand's connected mobility lab, managing teams of 5 to 18 engineers across multiple parallel projects
- Implemented Cloud Adoption Frameworks using Landing Zones and aztf
- Integrated AI adoption and fine-tuning into product development & services

Stack: Golang, Kotlin, Azure, GitLab CI/CD, Argo CD, AKS, Kubernetes, Buildpacks, Kaniko, Envoy, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Tempo, VictoriaMetrics, Terraform, Terragrunt, AI

DevSecOps Chapter Lead — JTI | Apr 2022 — Apr 2023

- Led DevSecOps chapter for JTI Digital Strategy Accelerate e-commerce stream (\$300K+/year infra budget, \$100K+/month team budget)
- Reduced cloud infrastructure costs by 68%
- Created operation readiness standard and backlog for technical improvement
- Ensured all live products were operationally ready
- Collected and executed requirements from JTI technical architecture and security teams
- Coached Software Engineers, Product Owners and stakeholders on DevOps principles

Stack: Azure, AKS, WebApp, Functions, APIM, Service Bus, Terraform, Terratest, Python, React, Adobe Cloud JS, GitLab, New Relic, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Cosmos DB, Redis, RabbitMQ, Aqua Security, SonarQube

Site Reliability Engineering Manager

Sep 2021 — Mar 2022 | Forte Group (for Donnelley Financial Solutions) — UA / US

- Led SRE and L3 Support team for a major American financial services company
- Drove transition from traditional support to SRE practices
- Established production observability and automated routine operations
- Hired, mentored, and developed the engineering team

Stack: Azure, .NET, PagerDuty, SolarWinds, Zabbix, MSSQL, GitHub, New Relic

Chief Information Officer

Jun 2020 — Dec 2021 | Asquid (N1 Management Company) — Ukraine

- Joined at idea stage; built the entire fintech product infrastructure from scratch (\$15K/year infra, \$50K+/month team budget)
- Achieved product profitability within 18 months of launch
- Passed PCI DSS audit for product certification
- Hired, educated, and mentored the full DevOps team

Stack: AWS, EKS, Terraform, GitLab, Java, JS, React, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, RabbitMQ, Redis, Kafka

Technical Operation Lead / DevOps Engineer

Oct 2009 — Aug 2021 | BetssonGroup via Ciklum — Ukraine, Sweden, Malta

- 12-year tenure building and operating payment systems for a global gambling group (\$100K+/year on-prem infra, \$100K/year AWS)
- Created and supported infrastructure for 37+ brands across 13 countries
- Introduced SLA metrics, Kubernetes adoption, and cloud migration strategy
- Maintained PCI compliance for 11 consecutive years
- Grew from System Administrator & DBA to Technical Operation Lead

Stack: AWS, EKS, VMware, Terraform, Ansible, .NET, MSSQL, RabbitMQ, Redis, Kafka

Senior System Administrator

Apr 2006 — Oct 2009 | LLC Astelit (mobile operator) — Ukraine

- Built physical and virtual infrastructure for offices and call centers
- Managed AD, Exchange, SharePoint, and database systems for the enterprise

Stack: MS Infrastructure, AD, VMware, MS SQL Server, Exchange, SharePoint

Education & Certifications

Master's in Information Systems — European University of Information Systems, Management and Business (EUFIMB), Kyiv, Ukraine

Specialty: Intellectual Systems of Decision-Making

Languages: English — Fluent (C1), Ukrainian — Native (C2), Spanish — Elementary (A2)

Certifications: AWS & Azure Cloud Solution Architect, ICAgile, Agile Project Management, Scrum / Nexus Framework, Hofstede's Cultural Model

Domains: Fintech & Payments, Automotive, E-commerce, Telecom, Gambling, Digital Security, Consulting

Latest recommendations and references available upon request. Full CV: taras.cloud/cv